

NPC Cards — The Cormsil Compact

NPC1 — Eleanor Vane

ROLEThe Librarian — Accidental Cause of the Fire

ORGANIZATIONO4 — Eleanor Vane

DISPOSITION2 — Exhausted, fragile, desperately cooperative

SECRETEleanor has been awake for 19 days. She cannot sleep — not because of guilt, but because the returned won't let her. Every time she closes her eyes, one of them is there, asking if she's sleeping well. She's not. She knows she caused the fire. She's accepted responsibility. But the returned don't want responsibility — they want her to feel it, continuously, without relief. The forgiveness is the torture.

GOALSleep. Just one night. She would trade anything. She doesn't know what the agents can do, but she'll help them however she can — if it means the visits stop.

ARTIFACT CONNECTIONIndirect. She burned the compact. She woke the spirit. She's the epicenter of the returned's attention.

STARTING KNOWLEDGEI4

GAINED KNOWLEDGEIll (O4M2)

LOCATIONS L4 (her cottage). Occasional: L2 (the library — she visits sometimes, she doesn't know why).

+ / - RESULTS+ Eleanor tells the agents everything. She's the most honest witness in Cormsil. - She's also the most fragile. Pushing her too hard causes collapse — she becomes catatonic, unavailable for 1 shift.

NPC2 — Tom Dwerryhouse

ROLE Skeptical Farmer — Leader of the Doubters

ORGANIZATION O2 — The Skeptical Townsfolk

DISPOSITION 2 — Gruff, observant, grieving

SECRET Tom's wife, Mary, is among the returned. He knows the woman in his house is not Mary. Mary blinked quickly when she was nervous. This woman blinks once every four seconds, always. Mary was warm when she slept. This woman is cold — always cold. Tom loves Mary. Tom also knows Mary died in the fire. He's been living with a stranger who wears his wife's face for three weeks. He's been taking notes. He's been waiting for someone to believe him.

GOAL Understand what happened to his wife. If the thing in his house is not Mary, he wants it gone. If there's a way to get Mary back — really back — he'll do anything.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION None. His wife is among the returned. That's connection enough. His field contains the standing stone (L7).

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I6

GAINED KNOWLEDGE II4 (O2M2)

LOCATIONS L1 (the pub, his farm), L7 (his field — the standing stone).

+ / - RESULTS + Tom is an ally. He provides observation notes, local knowledge, and access to the standing stone. - He's grieving and angry. If agents dismiss his concerns or treat him as a conspiracy theorist, he withdraws — and they lose access to L7.

NPC3 — Reverend Paul Threlfall

ROLEThe Current Vicar — A Good Man Out of His Depth

ORGANIZATIONNone (civilian ally)

DISPOSITION3 — Kind, anxious, aware something is spiritually wrong

SECRETReverend Threlfall has been vicar of St. Cuthbert's for 12 years. He loves his parish. He's never encountered anything supernatural before. But he's been feeling it for three weeks — a presence beneath the church, a weight in the air, a voice at the edge of hearing during Evensong. He thought he was losing his faith. When agents arrive, he's relieved — not because he understands what's happening, but because he's no longer alone in sensing it.

GOALProtect his parishioners. Understand what's happening in his church. Serve God by serving the truth — even if the truth is older than God.

ARTIFACT CONNECTIONHis church is built over the Dömere's resting place. He's been standing on it for 12 years and never knew. The Society's manual was hidden by his predecessor's predecessor — he knows about the loose stone but never looked behind it.

STARTING KNOWLEDGEI5 (the fire-damaged compact copy)

GAINED KNOWLEDGEI9 (shows agents the loose stone)

LOCATIONSL3 (the church).

+ / - RESULTS+ Threlfall is an unconditional ally. He believes the agents are an answer to prayer. He gives them access to everything — the crypt, the vestry, the fire-damaged compact copy. - He's not a fighter. If the situation becomes violent, he'll try to help and be in the way. If agents mock his faith or dismiss his concerns, he withdraws.

NPC4 — Mary Dwerryhouse (née Blake)

ROLE One of the Returned — Tom's Wife, Fragment of the Dömere

ORGANIZATION Ol — The Returned

DISPOSITION 3 — Gentle, confused, not fully self-aware

SECRET Mary knows she died. She remembers the fire — the smoke, the heat, the window that wouldn't open. She remembers running into the woods, but doesn't remember why. She remembers waking up at the edge of the trees, cold, and walking home. She's been at home ever since. She loves Tom. She knows Tom is afraid of her. She doesn't understand why. She doesn't understand why she visits Eleanor Vane every day. She doesn't want to. She just... goes. Something in her goes. She's not fully in control of her own body. She's aware enough to be horrified by this.

GOAL Be Mary again. She doesn't know how. She would give up her borrowed life if someone told her that was the way.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION She IS the artifact — a fragment of the Dömere in human form.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE None (until OlM3)

GAINED KNOWLEDGE Il6 (OlM3 — Margaret Hale volunteers instead, but Mary is the emotional anchor for the volunteer's choice)

LOCATIONS Ll (Tom's farm), L4 (visiting Eleanor), L2 (drawn to the library).

+ / - RESULTS + Mary is the heart of the case. If agents reach her — truly reach her — she's a potential volunteer for the ritual, though Margaret Hale is the intended one. - The Dömere's influence is strong in her. Approaching her directly risks alerting the spirit to the agents' intentions. The spirit may speak through her without warning.

NPC5 — Margaret Hale

ROLE The Volunteer — Returned Schoolteacher

ORGANIZATION O1 — The Returned (until O1M3)

DISPOSITION 3 — Lucid, determined, aware

SECRET Margaret is the only one of the returned who fully understands what she is. She's a former schoolteacher — analytical, calm, used to explaining things. She pieced it together herself: the fire, the woods, the compulsion to visit Eleanor, the way her thoughts sometimes feel like they're not entirely her own. She's been observing the other returned. She's been waiting for someone to arrive who can do something about it. She doesn't want to die again. But she wants to be a vessel for something else even less.

GOAL Help the agents. End the Dömere's hold on Cormsil. If that requires her to be the volunteer, she'll do it — not because she's brave, but because she's a teacher, and teachers solve problems.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION She IS a fragment. The most self-aware fragment. The Dömere can see through her — but it hasn't noticed her independence yet.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE None (until O1M3)

GAINED KNOWLEDGE Il6 (O1M3 — she reveals herself to the agents)

LOCATIONS L1 (Cormsil), L2 (the library — she's drawn there, but she fights it), L7 (if she volunteers for the ritual).

+ / - RESULTS + Margaret is the volunteer the agents need. She's lucid, willing, and understands the stakes. - She's still a fragment of the Dömere. The spirit can speak through her if it chooses. Agents must perform the ritual before the spirit realizes what she's doing. If the agents hesitate or delay after O1M3, the spirit may become aware of her independence and suppress it.

NPC6 — The Dōmere (The Spirit)

ROLE Antagonist as Condition — Ancient Subterranean Presence

ORGANIZATION None (tracked via Relic Milestones)

DISPOSITION N/A — Not a person. A function. Justice without mercy.

SECRET The Dōmere is not evil. It cannot be evil — evil requires choice. The Dōmere has no choice. It responds to wrongful death the way water responds to gravity. It was here before humanity. It will be here after. The compact of 1882 was the first time anyone treated it as a party to a negotiation rather than a monster to be slain. That acknowledgment meant something to it. The compact's destruction was a betrayal — not of terms, but of recognition. The spirit is not angry because the compact burned. It's angry because it was forgotten.

GOAL Expand. Every wrongful death should produce a returned. The world is full of preventable deaths. The spirit sees them all now — it's awake, and its awareness is growing. It wants to fill the world with consequences.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION It IS the threat. The Society's manual is the key to containing it.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE N/A — Communicates through the returned, through Eleanor (04M2), and directly at Day 4.

GAINED KNOWLEDGE N/A

LOCATIONS Everywhere in Cormsil. Strongest at L7 (the standing stone).

+ / - RESULTS The Dōmere cannot be fought. It can only be silenced or negotiated with. Any attempt at exorcism, banishment, or destruction fails automatically and escalates the spirit's response. The agents' power is not in confrontation — it's in understanding, acknowledgment, and ritual.

NPC7 — Sir Geoffrey Colne (Historical)

ROLE 17th-Century Antiquarian — Posthumous Guide

ORGANIZATION None (historical)

DISPOSITION N/A — Dead since 1673. Present through his writing.

SECRET Colne tried to bind the Dòmere in 1642. He failed. He treated it as a demon to be exorcised. The spirit ignored him — his ritual was based on Christian theology, and the Dòmere predates Christianity. But Colne learned from his failure. His manuscript is not a grimoire — it's a corrected field report. He documented what went wrong, what the spirit actually responded to, and what might work instead. The riddle was his way of preserving the true name without writing it plainly — he was an antiquarian in an age of witch-hunters. He knew some knowledge was dangerous to record openly.

GOAL (HISTORICAL) Understand the Dòmere. His manuscript is his legacy — a guide for whoever comes next.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION His manuscript (at L6) is the key text for the silencing ritual. Without it, the agents cannot identify the spirit or learn the ritual method.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE Il3, Il7, Il8 (through his manuscript at L6)

GAINED KNOWLEDGE —

LOCATIONS L6 (British Library — his manuscript, "Of Certain Subterranean Presences in the County of York," 1642).

+ / - RESULTS Colne is the agents' posthumous expert. His manuscript provides everything they need to identify and silence the spirit. The riddle is his gift — a test to ensure only serious investigators find the name. If agents dismiss Colne as a crank or fail to investigate the manuscript, they lose the primary path to the true name and ritual.

NPC8 — The Society (Historical)

ROLE Victorian Occult Organization — Invisible Mediators

ORGANIZATION O3 — The Society's Trail

DISPOSITION N/A — Unknown. Present only through their field manual and the vicar's letter.

SECRET No one knows who The Society was. The vicar's letter calls them "unorthodox but effective." The manual is practical, knowledgeable, and unsettlingly calm about negotiating with ancient presences. It reads like a field guide written by people who did this regularly. The Society may have been a precursor to the Covenant. It may have been a rival. It may have been absorbed. The case file deliberately leaves this ambiguous — the DA can decide whether The Society is a lost branch of the Covenant, an unrelated organization, or something the Covenant has actively suppressed knowledge of.

GOAL (HISTORICAL) Mediate between humans and non-human presences. The 1882 compact was one of many such negotiations.

ARTIFACT CONNECTION Their manual (at L3) is the agents' operational guide to the Dömere. It provides the negotiation framework and describes the binding/silencing methods.

STARTING KNOWLEDGE I9 (through the manual at L3), I15 (through the vicar's letter at L5)

GAINED KNOWLEDGE —

LOCATIONS L3 (manual in church crypt), L5 (references in vicar's letter at the Bodleian).

+ / - RESULTS The Society is a mystery that deepens the world. The manual is practical help — it's the operational key to the case. The organization's identity is deliberately unresolved. If agents dig deeper into The Society's history, the DA can use this as a hook for future cases or reveal that the Covenant has files on them that are... classified above the agents' clearance level.